

- 
- Jeremiah accepts his calling as a prophet
 - Compares himself to an almond tree
 - ch1v4-5,6-7
 - You can do this!
 - v9
 - The reluctant Prophet - who recognizes his own weaknesses.
 - Am I ready for this? Can I do this?
 - Serve a mission - serve in callings - whatever it is that God has called us to perform.
 - Overwhelmed and feels completely inadequate.
 - God is willing to work with people who aren't perfectly prepared.
 - He picks common people and then he shapes them and molds them and works with them.
 - God doesn't have to do this - he could just get on a heavenly megaphone.
 - He uses us, people like Jeremiah and Isaiah and you and me to fulfill callings
 - Because you and I are given the opportunity to grow and become more like Him through our service.
 - v11-12
 - Don't think you're waiting for a giant oak tree to grow up.
 - The Lord is going to hasten - accelerate - his work will go forward quickly.
 - v17-19
 - Get ready Jeremiah. It's not going to be fun, it's not going to be pleasant, but I am with you.

- 
- He has his mission call, his bags are packed.
 - It's much easier to get called to teach people far away, than it is people in your own city.
 - Ch2v5-9 -
 - His first message to the people is: Look at all the wonderful things God has given you.
 - God doesn't abandon you, God is the constant.
 - You might say, even though God is all powerful, he is the vulnerable one in the relationship.
 - He's the one who gets left behind over and over and over again and waits patiently for the return.
 - He's the one who constantly stands at the door and is misused by us.
 - Never the other way around.
 - The light is still on. Come back home.
 - Do I always trust God?
 - Do I sometimes turn away or start to be fearful?
 - That's what he's saying, he's like: I've got you!
 - I've done all these things for your ancestors.
 - Why would you walk away from the source of everything that sustains you?
 - v9 - You. Your children.
 - In any moment when you're feeling discouraged or feeling abandoned or hopeless
 - Remember God is with you and he has done these great things, and he will yet do great things.

- 
- ch2v13 - Forsaken the fountain of living water that is available for them.
 - Done a small amount of work to keep the living water in the cistern.
 - I don't go to church on Sunday to [] check a box - because it's the socially acceptable thing to do.
 - I go because my cistern needs repair and I don't have the power to repair it.
 - I go with a whole bunch of other people who are struggling with their cisterns as well.
 - And we have experiences where we invite the Lord in to help us fix those breaches in our cisterns of faith and hope and conversion to him, not only to repair it, but to fill it full - to overflowing.
 - In your life God will allow you to suffer and struggle.
 - And what is he doing? He is carving out cisterns in your soul which he can then fill to overflowing.
 - And without that cistern you can't fully experience the atonement.
 - So when you're being carved out in those painful life experiences, just know God is intending to fill that to the brim with the everlasting waters of his love
 - and it will be sweet after you have experienced the bitter.

- 
- Is there hope for us to obtain forgiveness from the Lord?
 - The Lord is merciful and wants us to return to him
 - with the acknowledgement we committed sin and we are remorseful.
 - ch3v12
 - He's saying, I'm not mad - I'm not an angry being - I want to bless you,
 - But I can't bless you if you won't return to me.
 - I can't treat you like a bride if you're out there with false worship.
 - v13
 - It's that acknowledgment, that recognition and meekly saying to the Lord: yeah, I've struggled.
 - v14
 - Turn: this is the word for repentance.
 - God isn't shaming them. He's saying, no, just come back.
 - Turn, return, turn around, - this is not about: I want you to feel guilty, I want you to feel shame.
 - This takes acknowledging that you're going the wrong way, and then you course correct and you come back.
 - See that God is - with open arms - willing to accept you.
 - Turn is also connected to gather - think of these arms that a mother uses to gather her children into her arms.
 - Also missionary work.

- 
- Jeremiah is telling us to not procrastinate
 - because good opportunities are lost.

- ch8v20

- How many of you struggle with procrastination.
 - Well the rest of you just haven't gotten around to raising your hands yet.
 - Whatever future you want for yourself, you have to choose today to start living that person now, because the future will happen.
 - If you don't start living that future self now, when you get there you will be a different person.
 - The only time you have agency is the now time.

- ch11v4&5

- Nutshell definition of the covenant. Your God <-> My People

- ch17v1&2

- You guys have sinned against God so often you've almost made it permanent.
 - God is still calling them and saying: I can wipe that all out.
 -

- 
- Not all is lost if we turn to God.
 - He is the Potter who will reshape the clay of our future
 - ch18v1-3, 4-5, 6
 - ch20
 -